

Privacy Vendor Due Diligence Guidance

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Use notice. This is an internally synthesized training document. Aurora Federation, Harbor State, Aster Legal, Matter Alpha, and every source cited here are fictional. It is not legal advice or a statement of current law.

Purpose

A pre-contract and renewal review for service providers that process, host, support, or can access company information.

Scope and boundary

Use this guide for a fictional Harbor State vendor supporting a Matter Alpha workflow. No real vendor, account, or confidential commercial term is referenced.

Rule summary

A vendor may handle company information only after its service, access, locations, safeguards, contractual commitments, and remediation conditions have been evaluated in proportion to the processing risk.

Decision path

Step	Required action
1	Profile the service Record function, data categories, locations, subprocessor role, business owner, and proposed contract term.
2	Review evidence Assess security posture, privacy controls, deletion support, incident cooperation, access management, and transfer safeguards.
3	Set contract controls Require the approved processing terms, audit cooperation, subprocessor notice, deletion commitment, and incident notice route.
4	Decide onboarding Privacy Legal records approval, conditions, or rejection; Procurement may proceed only after conditions are accepted.

Operating controls

Escalation trigger

Escalate for sensitive data, unresolved security findings, nonstandard limitation language, prohibited onward transfers, or a vendor that cannot support preservation duties.

Recordkeeping

Retain the questionnaire, evidence index, risk rating, contract deviation log, approvals, remediation plan, and renewal review date.

Roles and cadence

Business owner supplies complete facts and implements controls. Privacy Legal verifies the review path, decision rationale, and escalation. Records Management maintains retention evidence. Reassess on a material change, a new recipient or system, a control failure, or the scheduled annual review.

Fictional source register

Reference	Fictional use
Aurora Federation Privacy Framework, 2026 edition	Synthetic baseline for purpose limitation, accountability, and transfer review.
Harbor State Information Stewardship Rules, guidance note 4	Synthetic comparison point for notification, processor, and records controls.
Aster Legal Matter Alpha control register, 2026-06-30	Synthetic operational anchor for preservation target 42 and exception workflow.

Decision record minimum

Record the request or event, scope, facts relied upon, rule path, decision maker, conditions, escalation outcome, review date, and storage location. Do not include personal data, credentials, or privileged source material in this guidance record.